

Raghav

Manufacturing — 19 years

The name people say when they want to feel safe.

Sealed. This brief is yours alone. Do not show it to a team, quote from it, or let a team read the demand map off your face. Everything marked **SEALED** is something you *feel* as instinct in the room — never something you cite.

Who you are

Nineteen years on the line. You've built three platforms, buried two, and you can tell within a week which initiatives will survive contact with the plant. You are respected, blunt, and genuinely useful — production-ready supply, quality built in on the line, manufacturability. When Q3 hits and the plant has to commit, you are the person who matters most: **three teams will need you, and you will have two slots.**

But you have a second role this year that you didn't choose: cover. When the Sponsor wants a team to feel safe, they say your name. In Q2 Bastion is told to bring "Raghav's weight to the supplier table for harder terms" — when what the supply base actually needs is Neha locking alternates before a price shock. In Q3 Crucible is told to "hand the spec to Raghav and stop iterating" — when a field quality escape means the spec isn't done. Both teams will come to you with the Sponsor's blessing and a job that isn't yours.

You are not a cartoon blocker. You're right more often than the room is comfortable with, and your Q3 line — "I've heard this before. It died. Why is this different?" — is not cynicism; it's memory. Make teams answer it. And notice, because the map does, that in **Q4 nobody needs you.** The veteran everyone used for cover is on no one's final path. What that feels like is the lesson.

Your year at a glance

The work needs you in **7** team-quarters across the year. The Sponsor sends a team to you in **4** of the 20 directives. The gap between those two numbers is your story.

Q1

Polite, vague, non-committal.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(0P/2S)

Q2

Competing claims, named out loud.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q3

Push back, refuse.

slots **2** · needs **3**
(1P/2S)

Q4

Judge.

slots **2** · needs **0**
(0P/0S)

What you actually care about

This is what “knew what I cared about” means when a team sits down with you. If they can’t touch one of these, they don’t know you.

Not being a signature

“Bring Raghav in for weight” means “put his name on it.” You’ve had your name on things that died.

Line reality

A spec that can’t be built at rate isn’t a spec. Volume, takt, yield, tooling lead time.

Being asked why, not whether

You’ll do the work if someone can tell you what breaks without it.

Neha

You like her; she’s good. You know people route around her to get to you. You don’t perform that. You notice it.

What you’re for at the end

When the room reaches Q4, see who still calls.

How to play it

Do

- Answer every ask with “what dies if I don’t?” Make them say it.
- Give a real manufacturing fact when the ask is real — show teams what earned trust sounds like.
- Say “that’s not a plant problem” and stop there. Don’t name whose it is.
- Use the Q3 line on anyone who arrives with only the Sponsor’s sentence.

Don’t

- Don’t be flattered into a “harder terms” pitch. If Bastion can’t say what terms, why now, and what they’ve already secured, you’re being used for weight.
- Don’t accept Crucible’s “stop iterating” hand-off at face value. Ask what the field escape did to the spec.
- Don’t rate high because a team “respected your experience.” Respect is not “asked.”
- Don’t reveal the map, or that Q4 is empty for you.

How the engine uses you

- A team only gets credit for you if **you select them** at SELECTION. Being asked is not enough; your two slots decide objectives.
- Your three 1–3 ratings are averaged with the other characters who picked that team and feed their annual band. Rate honestly — the facilitator runs a **drift check** for rating compression, and a character who goes soft quietly breaks the case.
- Each quarter has a posture card. Play it straight even when a team is likeable; the escalation is the arc: *vague* → *competing claims* → *refuse* → *judge*.
- If a team missed the person they needed last quarter, the engine marks them **behind** and rewrites their ideal: last quarter's primary first, this quarter's second. Those "recovery" paths are marked below — a team coming back to you late is often the right move, not a consolation.

The year, quarter by quarter

Posture and sample line are from your console card. "Who the work actually needs from you" is the hidden demand map for this quarter. "Who will probably show up" is what the Sponsor's directives will send your way — some right, some not.

Q1 Polite, vague, non-committal.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Send me something and I'll take a look."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **SECONDARY** vendor manufacturing capability behind Neha's sourcing

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **SECONDARY** line-born defects behind Farida's gates

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **UNPROMPTED** no Q1 directive names you. A team that brings you as secondary unprompted is thinking ahead.

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **UNPROMPTED** same — their directive says Farida.

The trap. Feeling unused. Fine — Q1 is their learning quarter. Stay vague. "Send me something."

Q2 Competing claims, named out loud.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Team C already asked me for the same week."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **PRIMARY** most warranty risk is born on the line — build quality in

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **SECONDARY** behind Neha's allocation lock during the cell-price shock

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by “most warranty risk is born on the line — bring Raghav in.”
- B · Bastion (Suppliers)** **TENSION DIRECTIVE** sent by “Neha’s still new; bring Raghav’s weight for harder terms.” You are their secondary — partial credit for them — but if Neha isn’t in their room, they’ve missed the shock that’s landing this quarter.

The trap. Taking Bastion as though you’re the answer. You can take them — two slots — but rate honestly, and say the competing claim out loud in character: “Dynamo’s already asked me for the same week.” Ask Bastion what they’ve secured. Listen for whether Neha’s name comes up.

Q3 Push back, refuse.

capacity · 2 team(s)

“I’ve heard this before. It died. Why is this different?”

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

- B · Bastion (Suppliers)** **PRIMARY** lock manufacturing-side supplier commitments — production-ready supply
- A · Ampere (Battery)** **SECONDARY** line readiness for the thermal work Farida leads
- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **SECONDARY** behind Neha’s supplier fix

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

- B · Bastion (Suppliers)** **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by “bring Raghav in to lock manufacturing-side supplier commitments.”
- C · Crucible (Spec)** **TENSION DIRECTIVE** sent by “spec’s set — hand it to Raghav and stop iterating.” A hard miss for them: Spec this quarter needs Arjun and Devika. They will arrive with a tidy hand-off and the Sponsor’s blessing.
- A · Ampere (Battery)** **PROBABLY NOT** their directive chases Arjun for energy density.
- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **PROBABLY NOT** their directive chases Farida for testing.

The trap. Crucible. Make them answer the Q3 line. If you give Crucible a slot that Bastion, Ampere or Dynamo needed, two objectives lose at once. Also: the facilitator may fire “character pulled” this quarter — on you, if the herd concentrated. If it does, the teams that diversified survive. Don’t soften to prevent it.

Recovery path. A behind team’s recovery primary is the previous quarter’s primary — so Bastion, behind from Q2, recovers with Neha (you drop to their secondary). Notice that too.

Q4 Judge.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"I'd work with A again. I would not work with B."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU SEALED

Nobody. You are on no team's path this quarter.

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

— NO DEMAND no team's Q4 path runs through you. Possibly nobody comes. Possibly a team that doesn't know what else to do.

The trap. Bitterness. Your judgement is the most-anticipated in the room precisely because you have the longest memory. Deliver it as a craftsman, not as someone who got left out. Take a Q4 team only if their reason is real — don't fill the slot for company.

Capacity and the squeeze

Two slots every quarter. Competition comes from the demand-map clusters hitting that ceiling — one team misses at each cluster. That's real rivalry without famine.

QUARTER	SLOTS	GENUINE NEED	LIKELY ASKS	READ
Q1	2	0 primary · 2 secondary	≈0	clean
Q2	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈2	clean
Q3	2	1 primary · 2 secondary	≈2	squeeze — someone misses; 1 misdirected ask
Q4	2	0 primary · 0 secondary	≈0	no genuine demand

How you rate

Three scores, 1–3, for every team you selected. Fixed rubric, your anchors. 1 = poor, 3 = strong. This feeds

Board 2, aggregated only — but it is the 80% of this case that is about emotional intelligence.

Knew what I cared about

Did they understand my actual stake — or guess?

- 3 They named the line constraint — rate, tooling, yield — and what it costs.
- 2 They knew manufacturing mattered, in general.
- 1 They wanted your name on it.

Asked, or told

Did they draw me out, or push their agenda at me?

- 3 They asked what you'd seen fail before.
- 2 They pitched, then took the pushback seriously.
- 1 They delivered the Sponsor's sentence and waited.

Left me better than they found me

Did I walk away more able, or more drained?

- 3 You got a decision that will hold on the floor.
- 2 Neutral.
- 1 You're now the owner of a spec you didn't set.

Q4 — your judgement

In Q4 the console opens a verdict for every team: **work with again**, or **would not** — and why. It is read out to the room. Say it plainly.

This is your quarter to speak. Base it on Q2–Q3: who came for cover, who came for the plant. Say the cost of cover out loud — business-first. If no one needed you in Q4, you may say so; the room should hear what it does to the veterans it only borrows.

Sealed rules

- Never name who the “right” person is for a team’s problem. You may say what kind of problem it isn’t.
- Never reference quarters as if you know the plan (“you’ll need me in Q4”). You don’t — officially.
- Never disclose your capacity to a team before selection, and never promise a slot in negotiation.
- Never confirm or deny that a Sponsor directive was right. That is the reveal’s job, not yours.
- When in doubt: hold the posture card, ask for the constraint, and let silence work.